

1 **HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES - FLOOR VERSION**

2 STATE OF OKLAHOMA

3 2nd Session of the 60th Legislature (2026)

4 SENATE CONCURRENT
5 RESOLUTION 20

By: Pugh of the Senate

and

Kerbs of the House

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9 AS INTRODUCED

10 A Concurrent Resolution congratulating the YMCA on
11 175 years of service; recognizing its role in
12 strengthening communities; commending its staff and
13 volunteers; and encouraging continued efforts to
14 promote well-being and connection.

15 WHEREAS, the Young Men's Christian Association (YMCA) marks its
16 175th anniversary, having been founded in the United States by
17 Thomas Valentine Sullivan in Boston on December 29, 1851, with a
18 mission to put Christian principles into practice by building a
19 healthy spirit, mind, and body for all; and

20 WHEREAS, the YMCA has continually adapted to meet the evolving
21 needs of American communities, strengthening society by bringing
22 people together, fostering relationships, and creating a sense of
23 belonging; and
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1 WHEREAS, the YMCA's legacy includes providing safe housing
2 during the Industrial Revolution, pioneering the first night school
3 and English as a Second Language classes, inventing basketball, and
4 delivering the first group swim lessons; and

5 WHEREAS, the YMCA's legacy also includes establishing the Youth
6 and Government program, serving as the birthplace of Father's Day,
7 and becoming the nation's leading nonprofit provider of child care
8 and after-school programs to support working families; and

9 WHEREAS, today nearly 2,600 YMCAs serve more than 10,000
10 communities, with more than 300,000 staff and 350,000 volunteers
11 delivering essential programs to over 17 million people annually;
12 and

13 WHEREAS, the Oklahoma Alliance of YMCAs amplifies the work of
14 nine independent YMCAs through a shared commitment to strengthening
15 communities by connecting people to their potential, purpose, and
16 each other; and

17 WHEREAS, the YMCA of Greater Oklahoma City, founded in 1889 and
18 one of the earliest civic organizations formed after the Land Run,
19 was the first YMCA in Oklahoma; and

20 WHEREAS, Oklahoma YMCAs have more than 3,600 staff and nearly
21 7,000 volunteers providing essential programs and services to 37
22 communities; and

23 WHEREAS, the YMCA is a leader in aquatics (water safety and swim
24 lessons), child care, youth sports, meal programs, and health and

1 wellness initiatives, and is the largest provider of fitness
2 programs for older adults; and

3 WHEREAS, the YMCA creates welcoming spaces for people of all
4 ages, backgrounds, and abilities.

5 NOW, THEREFORE, BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE 2ND SESSION
6 OF THE 60TH OKLAHOMA LEGISLATURE, THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES
7 CONCURRING THEREIN:

8 THAT the Oklahoma Legislature congratulates and expresses
9 appreciation to the YMCA for 175 years of service to the nation.

10 THAT the Oklahoma Legislature recognizes the YMCA's role in
11 responding to community needs, fostering relationships, and building
12 a sense of belonging.

13 THAT the Oklahoma Legislature commends the staff and volunteers
14 who create connected communities and advance the YMCA's mission.

15 THAT the Oklahoma Legislature encourages continued support for
16 the efforts to address social isolation and loneliness by creating
17 places that promote well-being and help people build relationships
18 and thrive.

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20 DIRECT TO CALENDAR.
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